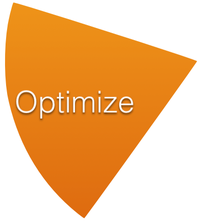
Search Engine Optimization (SEO)

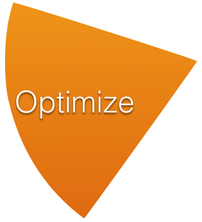
ITSS 3390

Prepared by: Angela Neal



What is SEO?

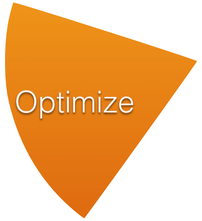
- Search Engine Optimization
- Process of taking steps to help a website rank higher on a search engine such as Google
- Process of taking steps to help a piece of content rank higher on a search engine such as Google
- Involves **organic** ranking
- Essentially taking a piece of online content and optimizing it so search engines display it higher on the page when it is searched



Why is SEO important?

Naturally users are more likely to click on search results found near the top of the Search Engine Results Page (SERP) which can lead to an increase in valuable conversions.

- Organic search results
- Quality of organic traffic
- Quantity of organic traffic



Why is SEO important?

Organic search results

- Unpaid listings on a Search Engine Results Page (SERP)
- Distinct from ads such as pay-per-click (PPC)
- Positioned based on the search engine's organic ranking algorithm and not advertiser bids
- It is not possible to pay for a higher ranking in organic search results

Quality of organic traffic

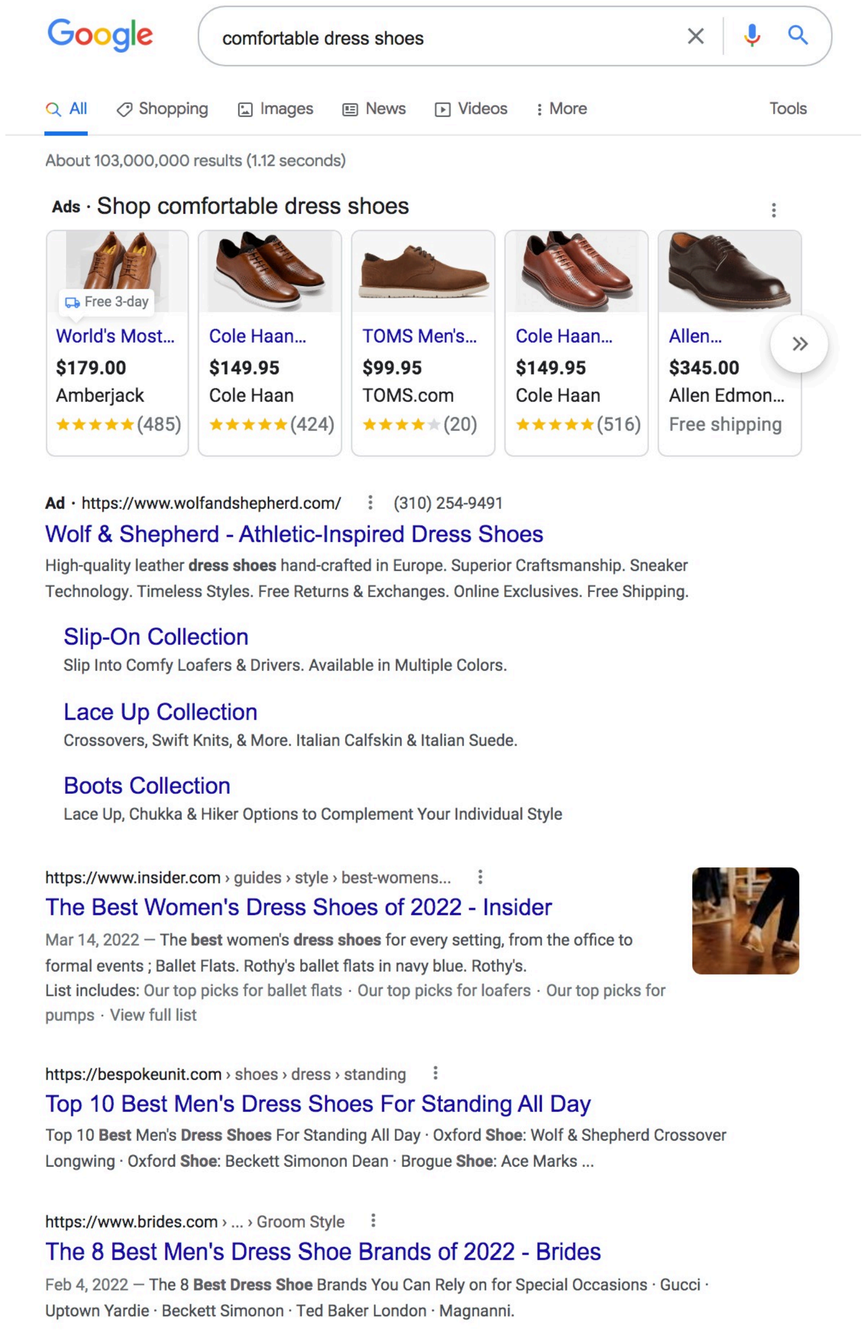
- Relevance of user search query and existing content on the website
- High-quality traffic includes visitors who are genuinely interested in the content offered on website
- High-quality SEO capitalizes on the search engine's effort to match the search intent of a user to the web page listed in the SERP

Quantity of organic traffic

- Number of users who reach the website via organic search results
- Naturally users are more likely to click on search results found near the top of the SERP
- The greater the number of high-quality visitors to the website, the more likely there would be an increase in valuable conversions

Optimize

Google search ranking example



Paid

Organic

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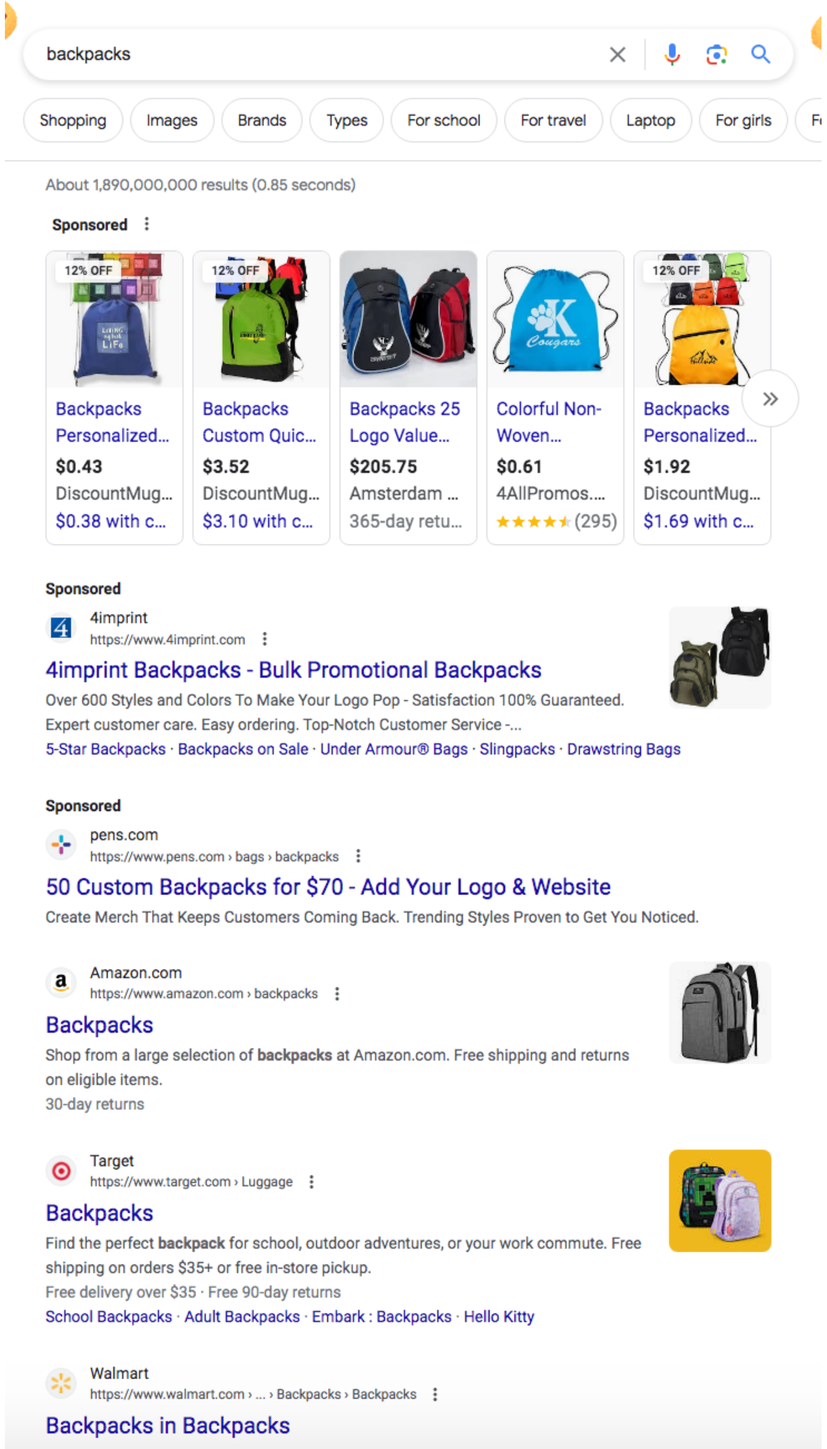
Optimize

Google search ranking example



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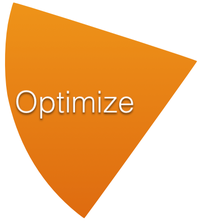

Google search ranking example

https://www.insider.com › guides › style › best-womens...

The Best Women's Dress Shoes of 2022 - Insider

Mar 14, 2022 — The **best** women's **dress shoes** for every setting, from the office to formal events ; Ballet Flats. Rothy's ballet flats in navy blue. Rothy's.
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Top 10 Best Men's Dress Shoes For Standing All Day

Top 10 **Best** Men's **Dress Shoes** For Standing All Day · Oxford **Shoe**: Wolf & Shepherd Crossover Longwing · Oxford **Shoe**: Beckett Simonon Dean · Brogue **Shoe**: Ace Marks ...

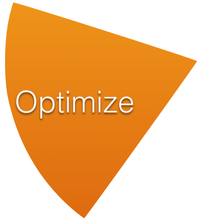
https://www.brides.com › ... › Groom Style

The 8 Best Men's Dress Shoe Brands of 2022 - Brides

Feb 4, 2022 — The 8 **Best Dress Shoe** Brands You Can Rely on for Special Occasions · Gucci · Uptown Yardie · Beckett Simonon · Ted Baker London · Magnanni.

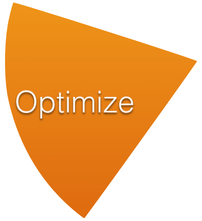
Title Tag - Displayed in the tab at the top of browser; shows when webpage turns up on Google. Generally 50 to 60 characters.

Meta Description - A brief description of what the content is about and is a maximum of 160 characters



How does SEO work?

- Search engines use **crawlers** which are also known as bots or spiders to collect information about all the content they are able to find on the internet
- Crawlers start from the known web page and then follows internal links in addition to external links to pages on other websites
- The crawlers use the content on the pages, the context of the followed links to understand what each page is about and how they are related or connected to all of the other pages within the search engine's large database.
    - The search engine's large database is called an **index**

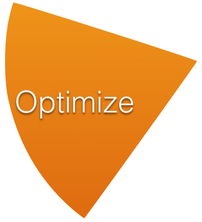


How does SEO work?

When a query is received into the search box, the search engine applies complex algorithms to extract what it interprets as the most accurate and useful list of results for the entered query.

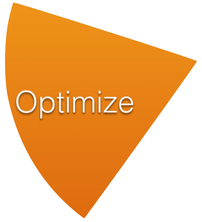
Organic results can include:

- Web pages
- News articles
- Images
- Videos
- Local business listings
- and more niche content



Sample list of ranking factors in Google's Algorithm?

- Domain-Level Link Features
- Page-Level Link Features
- Page-Level Keyword & Content
- Engagement & Traffic / Query Data
- Domain-Level Keyword
- Page-Level Social Metrics



Considerations to help increase Google Ranking

- Create backlinks
- Watch for broken links
- Be sure to use quality-written content
- Pay attention to your audience
- Be sure website is easy to access; easy to use
- Reduce Bounce Rate
- Consider keywords to target (in content)
- Title Tags
- Meta Descriptions

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